



Zane Rowe
Chief Financial Officer

2005
Founded

\$9.6B
FY2026 revenue

\$8.8B
Subscription revenue

\$25.96B
Subscription backlog

75M+
Users under contract

01 Who You're Meeting

Zane Rowe — Chief Financial Officer, Workday.

The company: Subscription revenue grew from \$7.7B to \$8.8B in FY2026, with subscription backlog of \$25.96B, up 17%. More than 75% of core customers use Workday Illuminate, and over a billion AI actions ran on the platform during the year.

What they sell: A unified platform for human capital management and financial management, with Workday Illuminate as the AI layer and a growing set of Illuminate Agents. Workday Build is a new open developer platform letting customers and partners create and share AI-powered solutions on Workday.

02 Where The Company Sits

Workday's claim is data, not models: Illuminate is trained on what it describes as the largest and cleanest finance and HR dataset, with more than 75 million users under contract and a trillion transactions processed in a year. For a portfolio programme the relevant point is that HR and finance are the two functions every PortCo has regardless of sector, which makes Workday one of the few genuinely portfolio-wide plays in the Corporate Functions Efficiency area of the reference model.

03 What To Pressure-Test

- Subscription growth of roughly 14–15% is solid but not exceptional against ServiceNow at 24.5%
- \$166M of restructuring expense in Q1 FY2026 pushed GAAP operating margin down to 1.8% for the quarter
- Four acquisitions in one year carries integration risk and makes organic growth harder to read
- Competes directly with SAP and Oracle, both of which bundle HCM and financials into wider estates

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. HR and finance are universal across PortCos, so this is one of the more plausible candidates for consolidated portfolio-level licensing. Note that Salesforce is a long-standing Workday HCM customer, and both vendors are tracked here.

BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of WDAY only.

Others at Workday: Carl Eschenbach (Chief Executive Officer)

www.workday.com · [Company LinkedIn](#)

Public professional and company information from the research layer of the GIP vendor tracker, generated September 15, 2026. Figures are as reported by the sources listed on the vendor's white page and are not independently audited. Research goes stale — re-run before external use.